US IPHONE APP STORE · FIVE-APP SNAPSHOT

The study-app market is established. The opportunity is a better exam workflow.

StudyFetch, Knowt, Coconote, Gizmo and Quizlet already offer overlapping combinations of uploads, AI study materials, flashcards and quizzes. “Upload notes, get questions” is not enough on its own.

Recommended positioning

Study Coach helps a college student turn real course materials and real exam dates into a checked study plan, source-grounded practice, and targeted review—without surprise paywalls or losing their work.

The decision in brief

Build first

Trust: cite source passages for generated answers, let the student review extracted dates/topics, and keep AI failures recoverable.

Then differentiate

Exams: configurable length, multi-document coverage, non-repeating questions, and review driven by missed concepts.

Keep

Student control: explicit AI actions, local access to saved study work, useful no-cost practice, and clear sharing choices.

Move up

Lecture capture: record by class, review the transcript, then use that lecture alongside notes and syllabus to generate questions. Defer voice tutors and podcasts.

What can and cannot be counted

Yes: Apple displays a count of *ratings* on each listing, plus selected written reviews. **No:** those counts are not written-review totals, downloads, purchases, subscribers or revenue. Apple does not expose a competitor’s app-unit sales in its public storefront; its download and sales analytics are for the publisher. None of the five verified apps has a public “number sold” figure I can substantiate.

Method: US storefront listings and the written reviews surfaced on those pages, checked September 28, 2026. Review examples are anecdotes, not a representative sample; prices and rating totals change.

Closest App Store alternatives

App	Overlap with Study Coach	Apple ratings*	Pricing shown
StudyFetch	Uploads, AI tutor, quizzes, flashcards, study plans, progress tracking.	~14K	Free download + IAP. Premium $19.99 monthly, $29 quarterly, $96 yearly. Other paid add-ons listed.
Knowt	Notes/PDFs into AI summaries, flashcards, practice tests, spaced repetition and exam prep.	~11K	Free Basic + Ultra. Official plan page: $24.99 monthly or $149.99 billed annually.
Coconote	Lecture recording and notes; AI summaries, quizzes and flashcards.	~17K	Free download + Pro IAP entries from $9.99 to $152.99. Apple lists several same-named offers without clear intervals.
Gizmo	PDF/notes/PowerPoint imports, generated cards/quizzes, spaced repetition.	~14K	Free download + Unlimited IAP entries from $6.99 to $309.99; intervals and offers vary.
Quizlet	Large library of user-made sets, study modes, document-to-card features, AI study guide tools.	~1.1M	Free download + Plus IAP entries including $9.99 and $44.99; storefront does not identify each interval here.

*Rounded rating counts as displayed by Apple, not written-review counts or sales. Multiple prices for Coconote/Gizmo/Quizlet are examples of available in-app purchase entries, not equivalent subscriptions. Verify the live checkout, region, term and renewal conditions before pricing decisions.

Who is closest?

StudyFetch is the most direct head-to-head competitor: its App Store description explicitly promises a plan built from uploaded materials, quizzes and personalized progress. **Knowt** competes on generous free study modes and exam prep. **Coconote** leads with lecture capture, while **Gizmo** emphasizes imported flashcards and repetition. **Quizlet** is the large distribution incumbent, not a one-to-one match for Study Coach's syllabus and deadline workflow.

What not to infer

A rating is submitted by a subset of users. It cannot be converted reliably into installs or subscribers. A competitor's advertised user count also is not an App Store sales count.

Five recurring problems in actual review comments

Three concrete examples were read for each competitor below. Titles identify the review as it appeared on the linked App Store listing; complaints are paraphrased rather than treated as verified product defects.

StudyFetch	*"Tutor Me Section needs improvement"* says the tutor repeats content from other notes or stops responding; *"MAKE MORE THINGS FREE!"* objects to unclear premium limits; *"Misleading Trial Offer & Constant Glitches"* alleges an unexpected charge and freezes. **Opportunity:** scoped context, honest entitlement display, durable drafts.
Knowt	*"Great Substitute for Quizlet…"* requests missing language-exam support and mobile parity; *"More diverse questions"* describes short, repeated, narrow tests over long material; *"Just ai AP stuff"* questions AI-generated study-source trust. **Opportunity:** source-grounding, adjustable length and coverage checks.
Coconote	*"Like it but needs improvement"* asks for cross-note chat and better navigation; *"Love this app! Have an Idea…"* requests timestamps linked to audio; *"Nice App…"* asks for longer exams and regenerated questions after notes change. **Opportunity:** combined-course exams and refreshable practice.
Gizmo	*"Amazing but could be Perfect"* describes cards repeating too soon and older cards disappearing; *"Couple of bugs…"* reports out-of-scope questions; *"Great for studying but issues"* reports lag, crashes and lost editing. **Opportunity:** review scheduling and source-scope controls.
Quizlet	*"It's meh."* describes poor screen-reader and text-size support; *"Used to be a good app"* says ads disrupt studying; *"Do better."* objects to paid learning/test modes. **Opportunity:** accessible practice and a dependable free core.

Not every comment is from the same date or review sort. App Store pages select reviews and can change which ones appear. A reviewer's allegation about billing, crashes or accuracy has not been independently reproduced here.

What to add—and what to fix first

P0 / trust and accuracy

01 **Show where each answer came from.** Store the source file and passage used for each generated question, and expose an “unsupported / wrong” correction path. When no passage supports an answer, say the question is general knowledge instead of pretending it came from a syllabus. This addresses distrust of invented or out-of-scope content in Knowt and Gizmo reviews.

P0 / student control

02 **Stage extracted dates and topics for approval.** Today Analyze adds its results directly to local study data. Let the student edit or reject each suggested item before it affects a schedule, with a link back to the document. Make any AI error recoverable without losing uploaded text or a quiz in progress.

P1 / course-tagged lecture capture

03 **Record and transcribe each class lecture.** Attach a recording to its course; let the student correct a timestamped transcript before using it. Generate questions from selected lecture passages together with the course’s syllabus and notes, and show which passage supports each answer. Make recording status, failure recovery and deletion clear.

P1 / stronger exam practice

04 **Build a cumulative mock exam.** Choose 10/20/40+ questions across files and lecture transcripts, cover selected topics, avoid near-duplicates and refresh questions after material changes. This responds to short or repetitive tests in Knowt and Coconote reviews.

P1 / practical access

05 **Offer export/print and accessible controls.** Validate keyboard, screen-reader and dynamic-text support; keep already-generated review available offline.

Pricing / test, not assumption

06 **Publish a simple free allowance before any paywall.** Show exact AI-use limits and renewal terms. Test a semester option only after measuring AI and transcription costs; listings alone do not establish the right price.

The differentiation is not microphone access itself: StudyFetch and Coconote already record lectures. It is the complete lecture-to-course-to-exam feedback loop. Later: voice tutors, podcasts and cross-device sync.

Sources and interpretation

Primary App Store listings and reviews

1. StudyFetch listing, pricing, ratings and featured reviews
2. Knowt listing, pricing, ratings and featured reviews
3. Coconote listing, pricing, ratings and featured reviews
4. Gizmo listing, pricing, ratings and featured reviews
5. Quizlet listing, pricing, ratings and featured reviews

Price and measurement references

6. Knowt official student plans ($24.99 monthly; $149.99 billed upfront annually)
7. Knowt help center: free study modes and AI-use limits
8. Apple App Store Connect Analytics: downloads, sales and publisher metrics

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Important distinctions

- **Apple ratings:** the visible star-rating participation count. It is not necessarily the number of written review comments, and one person can download without rating.
- **Sales:** Apple does not publish competitors' app-unit purchase totals or paid-subscriber counts on these listings. "Free · In-App Purchases" also means the download itself is not a paid app sale.
- **In-app prices:** the list can show many versions of the same named plan. Only StudyFetch and Knowt billing periods are clearly supported by the cited display/official plans used here.
- **Review evidence:** individual experiences indicate what to investigate; they do not establish how often the defect occurs or whether it still exists in the current version.
- **Study Coach comparison:** current features were checked against the workspace prototype. Recommended features on page 4 are not claimed to be implemented.

Bottom line

There is clear competition and clear demand. Differentiate on grounded, adjustable exam preparation and trustworthy behavior—not a larger menu of AI tools.